

Introductory (Project Topic Interest)

As young adults, our focus naturally starts shifting towards becoming independent individuals, including the goal of living on our own and eventually becoming homeowners to complete part of the American Dream. However after experiencing high rent firsthand, this goal then starts to feel somewhat impossible. Housing affordability seems to be an increasingly urgent issue, especially in Charlotte, North Carolina. This then sparked our interest in figuring out and identifying the key factors that most contribute to housing unaffordability and then use that to identify the neighborhoods most at risk of displacement. The topic is even more so interesting due to the rising housing costs disproportionately affecting lower-income families and historically marginalized communities. This frequently forces residents out their homes and enforces the history of discriminatory practices such as redlining mapping. Redlining was used to mark hazardous neighborhoods in terms of investment which usually related to minority based neighborhoods. This raises questions about whether old policies continue to frame present-day outcomes.